

Guidelines for Final Submission: Formatting and Structure for Academic Research Papers

APA Formatting Guidelines:

- **Font:** Times New Roman.
 - **Font Size:** 12-point.
 - **Line Spacing:** Double-spaced throughout the document, including the title page, abstract, main body, and references.
 - **Margins:** 1-inch margins on all sides.
 - **Indentation:** Use a 0.5-inch indent for the first line of each paragraph.
 - **Title Page:** Centered title, author's name, institution, course name, instructor's name, and due date.
 - **Headers:** Include a page number in the top right corner and a running head on the top left (for professional papers).
 - **References:** Hanging indent for all entries; double-spaced.
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Title:

- Clearly conveys the topic of the research.
 - Should be concise, engaging, and informative.
 - Hints at the study's focus (e.g., key themes or methodologies).
 - Appears prominently on the first page.
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Abstract:

- Concise summary of the entire document.
 - Includes objectives, methodology, key results, and conclusions.
 - Positioned at the beginning, often before the table of contents.
 - Helps readers decide if the document is relevant.
 - Focused on essential points, no detailed background or explanations.
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Introduction:

- Introduces the topic and sets the context.
- Provides background information, states the problem, and explains the study's importance.
- Positioned as the first section of the main body.
- Engages readers with detailed context and research rationale.
- Broader scope, includes objectives and sometimes a brief literature review.

Research Questions:

- Defines the scope and direction of the research.
- Includes one main question addressing the overarching goal.
- Contains three sub-questions exploring specific aspects of the topic.
- Provides a foundation for data collection and analysis.

Literature Review:

- Contextualizes the research within existing studies.
- Reviews 10 relevant scholarly works.
- Highlights gaps or areas for further exploration.
- Summarizes key findings from previous research and their relevance to the study.
- Establishes a theoretical or conceptual framework.

Methodology:

- Explains how the research was conducted.
- Describes the approach: quantitative, qualitative, or mixed methods.
- Details participant selection criteria and sample size.
- Lists instruments used for data collection, such as questionnaires and interviews.
- Ensures transparency and replicability of the research process.

Data Analysis:

- Presents and interprets collected data.
- Uses charts, diagrams, and statistical tools to summarize findings.
- Explains trends, patterns, and relationships within the data.
- Lays the groundwork for the discussion section.
- Emphasizes clarity and accuracy in presenting results.

Discussion Section:

- Analyzes and interprets the results in detail.
- Explains how findings relate to research questions or hypotheses.
- Compares results with previous studies.

- Discusses implications, limitations, and future research potential.
 - Detailed and analytical tone.
 - Positioned before the conclusion in the main body.
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Conclusion:

- Summarizes the study's main findings and significance.
 - Reiterates key results and broader implications.
 - May briefly mention limitations or future research directions.
 - Concise and reflective tone.
 - Positioned at the very end of the document.
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Reference Page:

- Lists all sources cited in the document.
- Includes 12–15 references, formatted according to a standard style (e.g., APA).
- Ensures credibility and proper acknowledgment of prior work.
- Helps readers locate original sources for further reading.
- Hanging indent for all entries; double-spaced throughout.